

COMPLETE TRAVEL GUIDE

Tokyo and Kyoto by train

10 days in Tokyo and Kyoto by train, built around scenic viewpoints, history and culture and markets and street food.

WHEN
5 Apr – 14 Apr 2027

LENGTH
10 days · 9 nights

WHO
2 adults

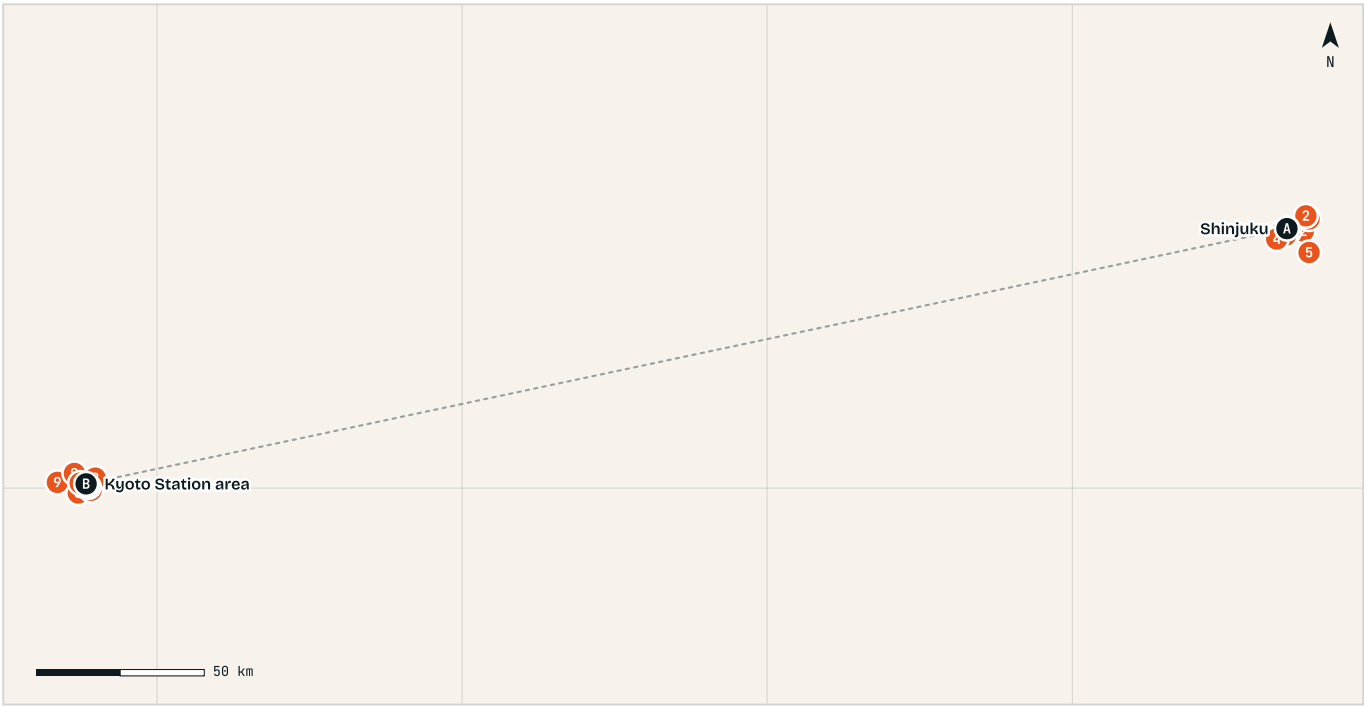
ROUTE
Shinjuku → Kyoto Station area

Planned with Sidequest · 13 November 2026
All times are local (GMT+9, Asia/Tokyo)
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TRIP AT A GLANCE

The shape of the trip

DAYS	STAYS	STOPS	DRIVING
10	2	18	16 km



Letters are where you sleep; numbers are the day each stop falls on. Solid lines follow measured routes; dashed lines are straight connections, not roads.

Where you sleep

A **Shinjuku** · 5 nights · Mon 5 Apr – Fri 9 Apr

B **Kyoto Station area** · 4 nights · Sat 10 Apr – Wed 14 Apr

Built around

Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck · Day 1
Free city-wide view at sunset, satisfying the viewpoint priority without the Skytree crowds

Tokyo National Museum · Day 2
Japan's largest collection of art and artifacts, a solid rainy-day option

Nijo Castle · Day 9
Shogun-era castle with famous nightingale floors, central and easy to reach

Imperial Palace Park · Day 2
A core stop, confirmed as a place on the map, on day 2.

Shinjuku Gyoen · Day 3
A core stop, confirmed as a place on the map, on day 3.

Throughout the trip

- Travel times on this day are Sidequest's estimates from map distance, not measured routes.

DAY BY DAY

10 days

Times are local (GMT+9). A time marked ≈ follows a journey estimated from the map; a part of the day stands in where a journey could not be timed.

DAY 1

Monday 5 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 40 min on the move

Arrive in Shinjuku · Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck

Walk to Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck · 20 min

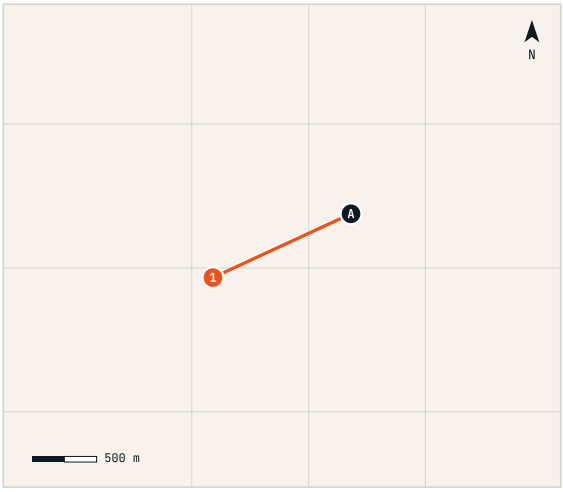
16:30 **1 Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck** · 45 min
Holds up even if the weather turns.

Walk to Shinjuku · 20 min

18:00 Dinner — なか卯新宿職安通り店

19:00 Free time

PLAN B Anything that runs late or closes: Keep this afternoon flexible.



DAY 2

Tuesday 6 April · Shinjuku · Moderate day · 3 hr 10 min on the move

Tokyo National Museum + 2 more

Train to Imperial Palace Park · ≈ 35 min

≈ 09:35 **1 Imperial Palace Park** · 1 hr
85 min on foot — further than you said you would usually go, but a strong enough fit that it earns the extra travel.

Train to Tokyo National Museum · ≈ 30 min

≈ 11:05 **2 Tokyo National Museum** · 2 hr

Walk to Yanaka Ginza · ≈ 25 min

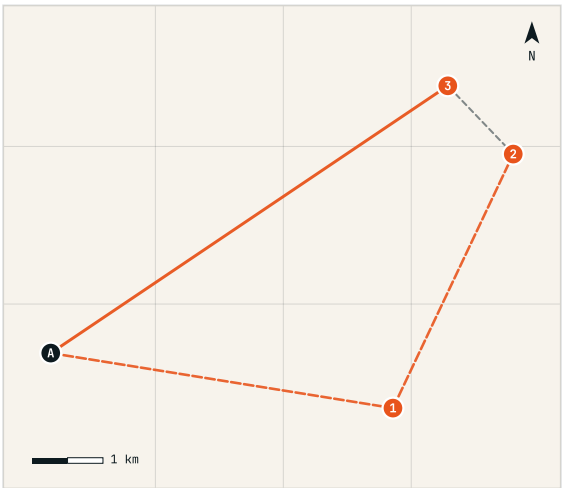
≈ 13:30 Lunch — 音音上野バンブーガーデン店

≈ 14:15 **3 Yanaka Ginza** · 1 hr
Old-town shopping street with a local feel, avoiding the tourist-trap districts

Bus to Shinjuku · 1 hr 40 min

≈ 16:55 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — Shogun Burger



PLAN B Anything that runs late or closes: Keep the afternoon flexible: Yanaka Ginza can move or go.

DAY 3

Wednesday 7 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 35 min on the move

Shinjuku Gyoen

Walk to Shinjuku Gyoen · 20 min

09:20 1 **Shinjuku Gyoen** · 1 hr 30 min
One of Tokyo's best cherry blossom parks, timed perfectly for the April dates

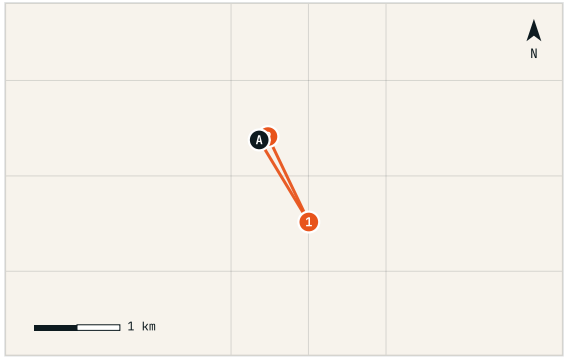
Walk to Golden Gai · 20 min

11:05 Free time

18:00 2 **Golden Gai** · 1 hr 30 min
Tiny bar alleys for one of the late nights the traveller is open to

19:35 Dinner — Wagyu (Halal Vegan) Hamburger Steak & Ramen Shinjuku Kabukicho Restaurant Beef Tei

20:35 Free time



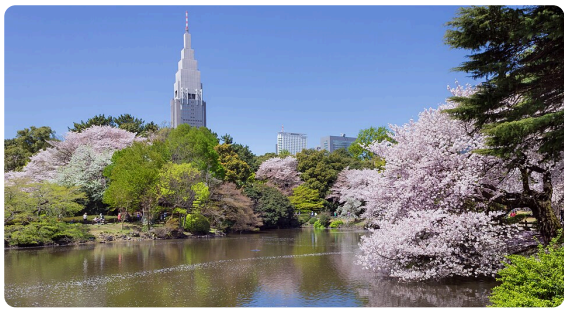


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DAY 4

Thursday 8 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 1 hr 30 min on the move

Meiji Jingu & Shimokitazawa

Train to Meiji Jingu · ≈ 25 min

≈ 09:25 1 **Meiji Jingu** · 1 hr
Minutes from where you are staying, so it fits any day.

Train to Shimokitazawa · ≈ 30 min

≈ 10:55 2 **Shimokitazawa** · 1 hr 30 min
A quieter local district with cafes and vintage shops, a break from the famous sights

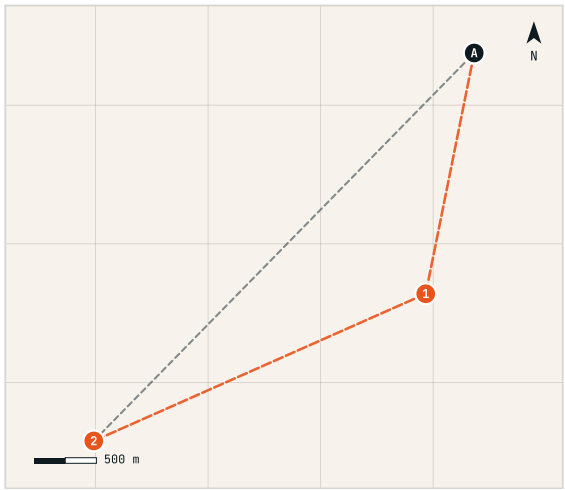
≈ 12:25 Lunch — coto cafe

Bus to Shinjuku · ≈ 35 min

≈ 13:45 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — Chaya Macrobiotics Isetan Shinjuku

PLAN B Anything that runs late or closes: Keep the afternoon flexible: Shimokitazawa can move or go.



DAY 5

Friday 9 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 1 hr 35 min on the move

Odaiba Seaside Park

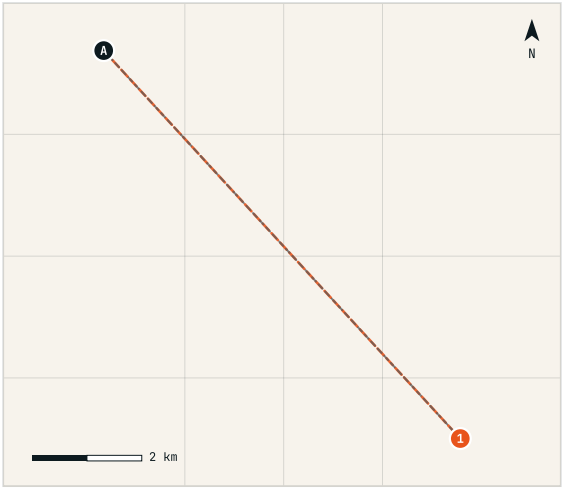
Train to Odaiba Seaside Park · ≈ 45 min

≈ 09:45 Free time

≈ 16:30 1 **Odaiba Seaside Park** · 1 hr 30 min
160 min on foot — further than you said you would usually go, but a strong enough fit that it earns the extra travel.

Bus to Shinjuku · ≈ 50 min

≈ 18:50 Dinner — Dancing Crab Tokyo



DAY 6

Saturday 10 April · Kyoto Station area · Light day · 4 hr 35 min on the move

On to Kyoto Station area · Kyoto Railway Museum

Moving on: Shinjuku → Kyoto Station area

09:00 Breakfast — Breakfast in Shinjuku before heading out

Train to Kyoto Station area · ≈ 3 hr 30 min
Train to Kyoto Railway Museum · ≈ 30 min

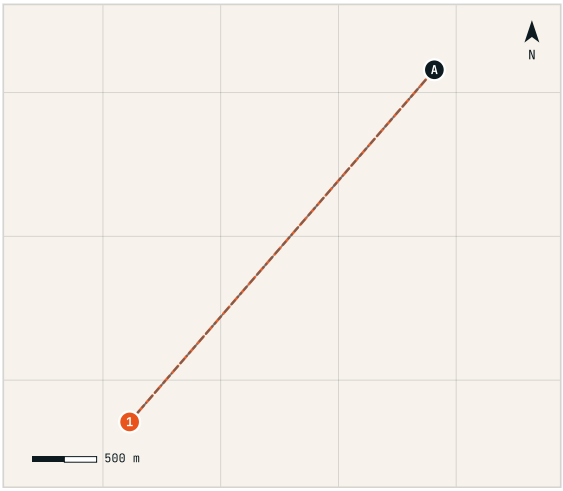
≈ 13:30 Lunch — Shava Liva

≈ 14:15 1 **Kyoto Railway Museum** · 1 hr 30 min
Sits right in the middle of famous and quiet, which is the mix you asked for.

Bus to Kyoto Station area · ≈ 35 min

≈ 16:20 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — Sinamo



NOTE You move from Shinjuku to Kyoto Station area today.

NOTE The move to Kyoto Station area is about 3 h 30, past your 2 h 30 a day: a travel day. A flight between them may be quicker; Sidequest has not timed one, so check before you book.

DAY 7

Sunday 11 April · Kyoto Station area · Light day · 50 min on the move

Kiyomizu-dera

05:30 Breakfast — Early breakfast in Kyoto Station area before heading out

Train to Kiyomizu-dera · ≈ 25 min

≈ 06:25 1 **Kiyomizu-dera** · 1 hr 30 min
Hillside temple with a famous wooden stage view over Kyoto, worth an early visit

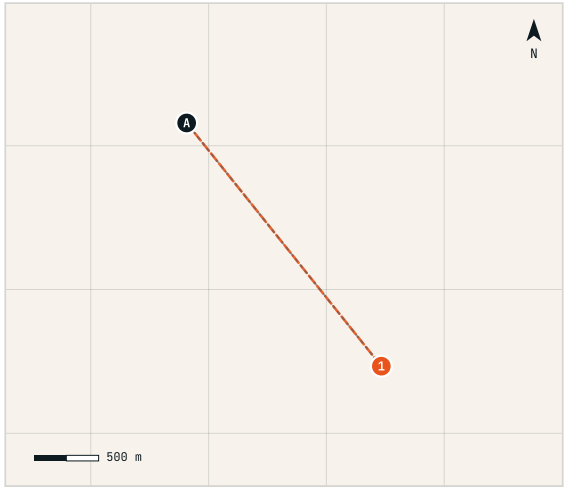
≈ 07:55 Free time

≈ 11:30 Lunch — 上島珈琲店京都寺町店

Walk to Kyoto Station area · time not measured

Late morning Free time

Early evening Dinner — Motoi



NOTE 1 travel leg on this day could not be timed; times are shown as parts of the day.

PLAN B Rain or strong wind on day 7: Fushimi Sake District (small town), close to where you are staying

DAY 8

Monday 12 April · Kyoto Station area · Moderate day · 1 hr 35 min on the move

Gion District + 2 more

Walk to Nishiki Market · 15 min

09:15 1 **Nishiki Market** · 1 hr
Kyoto's famous food market, good for a wandering lunch

Train to Ginkaku-ji · ≈ 30 min

≈ 10:45 2 **Ginkaku-ji** · 1 hr
The silver pavilion at the end of the Philosopher's Path, quieter than Kinkaku-ji

Train to Gion District · ≈ 30 min

≈ 12:15 Lunch — キーズカフェ 京都八坂の塔店

≈ 13:00 3 **Gion District** · 1 hr 30 min
Traditional geisha district, best explored in the quieter early evening

Walk to Pontocho Alley · ≈ 15 min

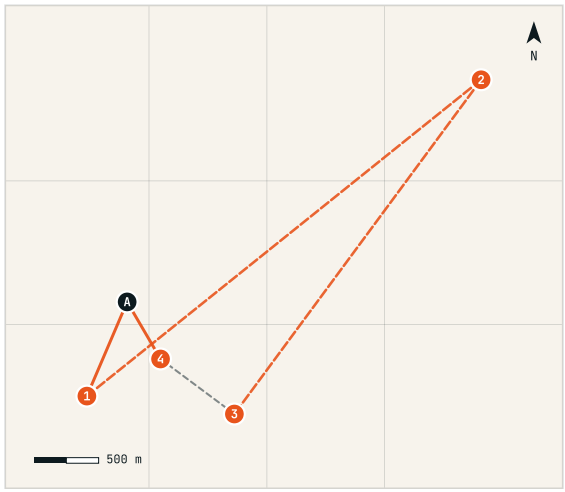
≈ 14:45 Free time

≈ 18:00 4 **Pontocho Alley** · 1 hr 30 min
Riverside dining alley for the trip's one special meal

Walk to Kyoto Station area · 10 min

≈ 19:40 Dinner — お食事 Choice Restaurant

≈ 20:40 Free time



DAY
9

Tuesday 13 April · Kyoto Station area · Moderate day · 2 hr 20 min on the move

Nijo Castle + 2 more

Train to Tenryu-ji · ≈ 45 min

≈ 09:45 **1 Tenryu-ji** · 1 hr
Zen garden temple adjoining the bamboo grove, pairs naturally with the walk

Train to Kinkaku-ji · ≈ 35 min

≈ 11:20 **2 Kinkaku-ji** · 45 min
The golden pavilion, a must-see despite crowds, best early

Train to Nijo Castle · ≈ 30 min

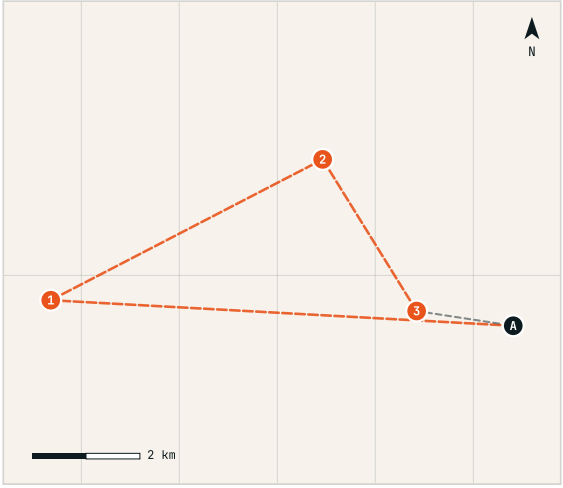
≈ 12:35 Lunch — Piopiko

≈ 13:20 **3 Nijo Castle** · 1 hr 30 min

Walk to Kyoto Station area · ≈ 30 min

≈ 15:20 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — 焼肉どうらく 京都六角通り店



DAY
10

Wednesday 14 April · Kyoto Station area · Light day

Departure

09:00 Free time

ACCOMMODATION & TRANSPORT

Where you sleep, and how you move

STAY	NIGHTS	DATES	STATUS
Shinjuku	5	Mon 5 Apr – Fri 9 Apr	TO BOOK
Kyoto Station area	4	Sat 10 Apr – Wed 14 Apr	TO BOOK

Getting around

- 1 hotel move, in the order that keeps the journeys between bases shortest.
- Consider a Suica or Pasmo IC card for all local trains, buses and convenience stores
- A Hakone Freepass covers the loop's trains, ropeway, cable car and boat
- Book Shinkansen seats a few days ahead especially around early April cherry blossom season
- Kyoto city buses get very crowded; subway or walking is often faster for central sights
- Public transport first: most hops between stops are rides rather than walks; a typical day has about 40 minutes of travel, estimated from...

Moving between stays

DAY	FROM	TO	HOW
6	Shinjuku	Kyoto Station area	Train · ≈ 3 hr 30 min

BOOKINGS & PREPARATION

Before you go

What to book

ITEM	WHEN	WHAT TO DO	STATUS
5 nights in Shinjuku Essential	Mon 5 Apr	Book somewhere to sleep in Shinjuku	TO BOOK
4 nights in Kyoto Station area Essential	Sat 10 Apr	Book somewhere to sleep in Kyoto Station area	TO BOOK
Train: Shinjuku → Kyoto Station area Recommended	Sat 10 Apr	Book the train to Kyoto Station area By Seats usually open about 30 days ahead	TO BOOK

To do before you leave

- [ ] Check the official entry requirements for your nationality before you book anything.
- [ ] Check current cherry blossom forecast as timing shifts yearly
- [ ] Check opening hours and any closures for Owakudani ropeway
- [ ] Check entry requirements and any visa rules for Japan before travel
- [ ] Reserve Ghibli Museum tickets well in advance, they sell out early
- [ ] Check teamLab Planets ticket availability and book online
- [ ] Passport validity: Add your passport expiry month.
- [ ] Visa or entry permission: Add your citizenship, or check the official source directly.
- [ ] Add a Suica or PASMO card to your phone, or buy one at the airport: Set this up before you fly.
- [ ] Get an International Driving Permit before leaving home: Set this up before you fly.

Packing

ESSENTIAL DOCUMENTS

- [ ] Passport or ID, valid for the trip
- [ ] Printed and offline copies of bookings and documents

CLOTHING

- [ ] Warm layers: fleece or wool mid-layer, warm hat
- [ ] One smarter layer (optional)

WEATHER

- [ ] Windproof layer

FOOTWEAR

- [ ] Comfortable walking shoes with grip

ELECTRONICS

- [ ] Power bank

TRANSPORT

- [ ] Transit pass or contactless card

PRACTICAL REFERENCE

Keep this page handy

EMERGENCY **110**

The general emergency number in Japan (119 ambulance and fire). Confirm locally; reference facts compiled by Sidequest.

DRIVING
On the left

MONEY
JPY

PLUGS
Type A, B · 100 V

CALLING CODE
+81

TIME ZONE
GMT+9 · Asia/Tokyo

Scan to open

This trip in Sidequest
Your live copy: changes, Today view and offline pages.

Day 1 in Google Maps
Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck

Day 2 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

Day 3 in Google Maps
2 stops, in order

Day 4 in Google Maps
2 stops, in order

Day 5 in Google Maps
Odaiba Seaside Park

Day 6 in Google Maps
Kyoto Railway Museum

Day 7 in Google Maps
Kiyomizu-dera

Day 8 in Google Maps
4 stops, in order

Day 9 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

APPENDIX

Planning notes and reference

How this plan was put together

Shinjuku (5 nights), then Kyoto Station area (4 nights), with each day's stops grouped around where you sleep.

Opening hours and access are checked when the plan is built where a provider has them; check the rest before you go.

Public transport times are estimates; no timetable was consulted.

Public transport first: most hops between stops are rides rather than walks; a typical day has about 40 minutes of travel, estimated from distance — no timetable was consulted.

Worth skipping, for how you travel

- **Hakone Open-Air Museum** — 21 hr 30 min each way on foot is past how far you said you would go.
- **Odaiba Seaside Park** — 2 hr 40 min each way on foot is past how far you said you would go.
- **Fushimi Sake District** — 2 hr 30 min each way on foot is past how far you said you would go.
- **Imperial Palace Park** — 1 hr 25 min each way on foot is past how far you said you would go.
- **Kibune Shrine** — 26 hr 30 min each way on foot is past how far you said you would go.
- **Odawara Castle** — 19 hr 30 min each way on foot is past how far you said you would go.

Budget estimate (USD)

Lodging 9 nights × one room at a midrange band	532–1,123
Food 10 days of everyday meals at a midrange band, plus one meal worth booking	289–591 pp
Activities 8 stops that usually charge entry	79–237 pp
Local transport 10 days of local transit and short rides	39–131 pp
Long distance transport 0 internal flights, 1 train leg, 0 ferry or boat legs	15–120 pp
Miscellaneous A small daily allowance for the unplanned	33–99 pp
Estimated total	**USD 1,442–3,479**

Figures are in US dollars. Estimates only; no price on this page was checked live.

Positions

Type a pair into any map app's search box.

1	Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck	35.689325,139.691813
2	Imperial Palace Park	35.686782,139.757144
2	Tokyo National Museum	35.719045,139.775968
2	Yanaka Ginza	35.727697,139.765723
3	Shinjuku Gyoen	35.685176,139.710052
3	Golden Gai	35.694112,139.704761
4	Meiji Jingu	35.676398,139.699326
4	Shimokitazawa	35.665786,139.669863
5	Odaiba Seaside Park	35.630049,139.775691
6	Kyoto Railway Museum	34.987099,135.742273
7	Kiyomizu-dera	34.994666,135.784661
8	Nishiki Market	35.005026,135.764723
8	Ginkaku-ji	35.027021,135.798206
8	Gion District	35.003782,135.777245
8	Pontocho Alley	35.007609,135.770984
9	Tenryu-ji	35.015838,135.673765
9	Kinkaku-ji	35.03937,135.729243
9	Nijo Castle	35.014038,135.748426

Credits

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